

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING ALPHA CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U8 (born in 2019 or after) U14 (born in 2013 or after)
- U10 (born in 2017 or after) U16 (born in 2011 or after)
- U12 (born in 2015 or after) U18 (born in 2009 or after)

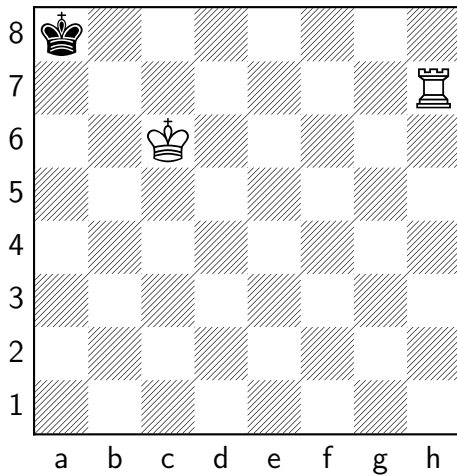
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You may leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions generally go from easy to hard, so it's best to start from the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and the marks you can score. Please write your answers in the space under each diagram. Altogether, the test has 100 marks. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial marks.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example Q1. Mate in 2.

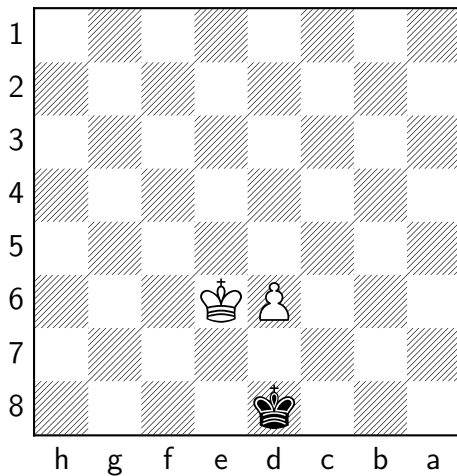


☐ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8 ← Write the first White move, then the first Black move.
2. Rh8# (1-0) ← Write the second White move, which is a mate.

Example Q2. Black moves and draws.

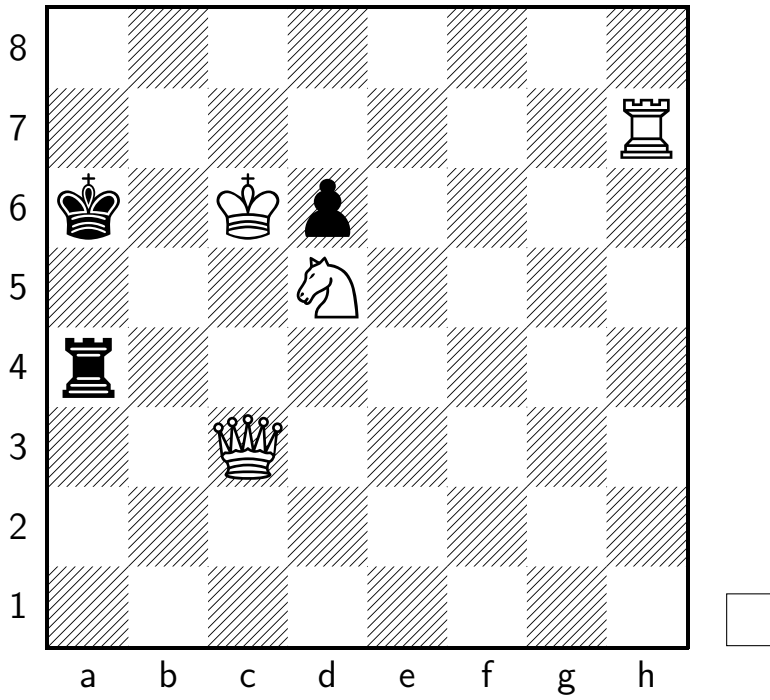


☒ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8
3. Kd6 (draw) ← Write enough moves showing a clear draw position.

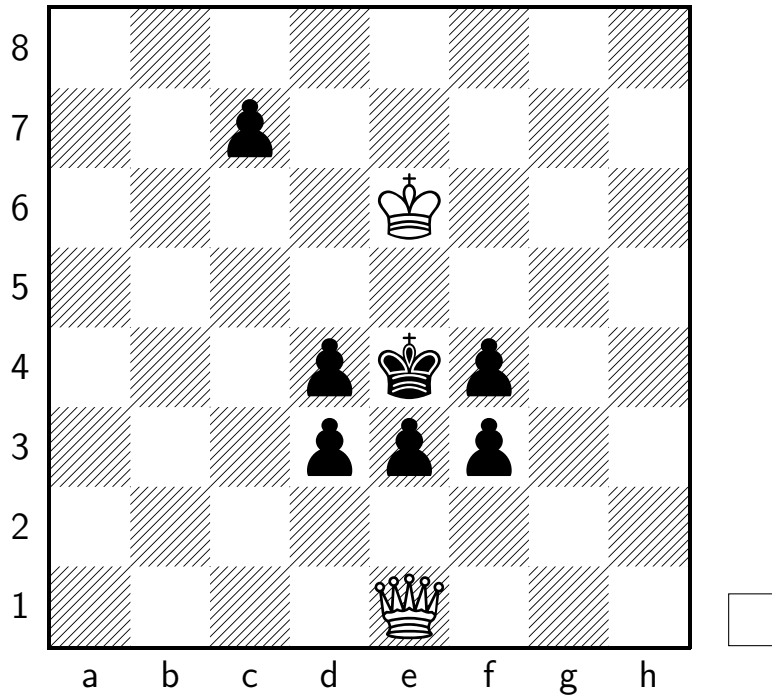
Q1. Mate in 2. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Jeff Coakley, Winning Chess Puzzles for Kids Vol. 2

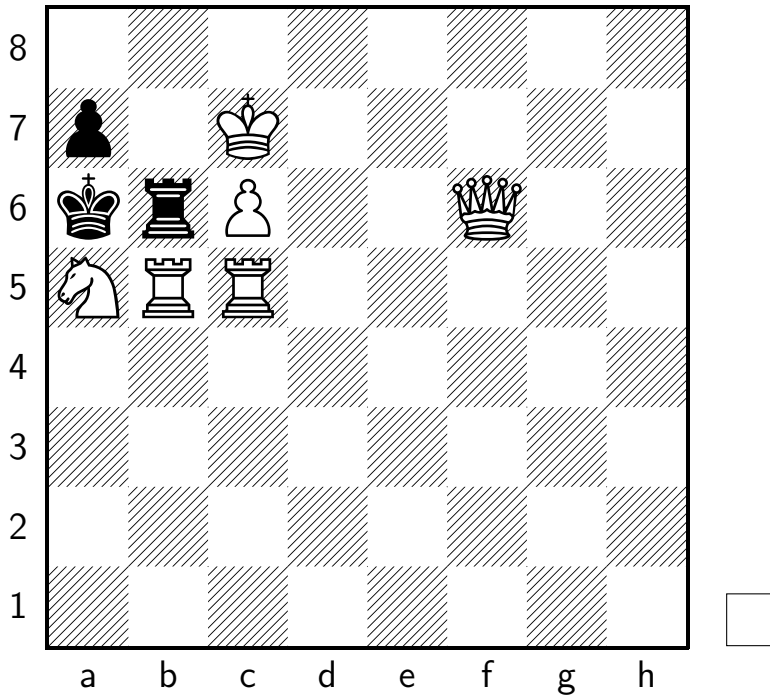
Q2. Mate in 2 (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Thomas Salthouse, Falkirk Herald, 1914 (YACPDB: 22264)

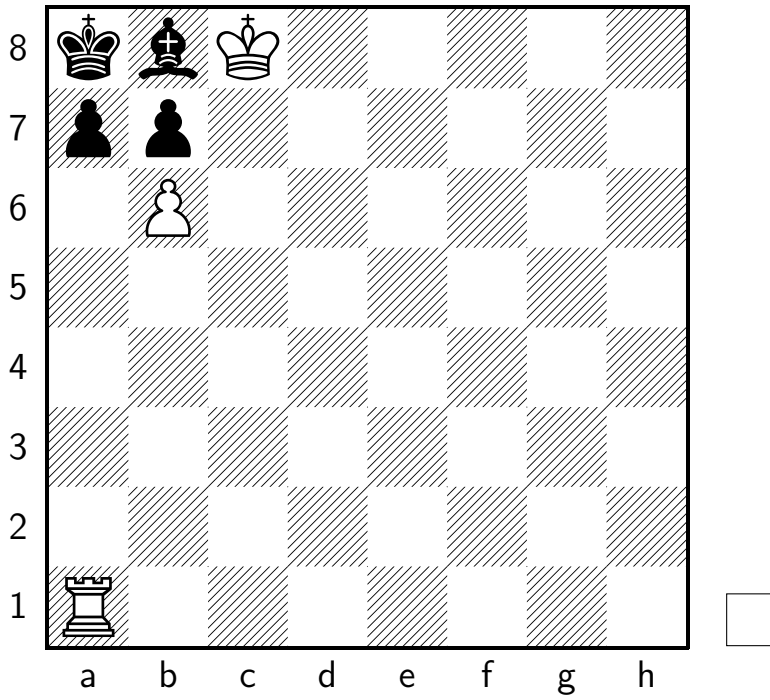
Q3. Mate in 2. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Cornelis Goldschmeding, problem (Zagreb), 1957 (YACPDB: 8721)

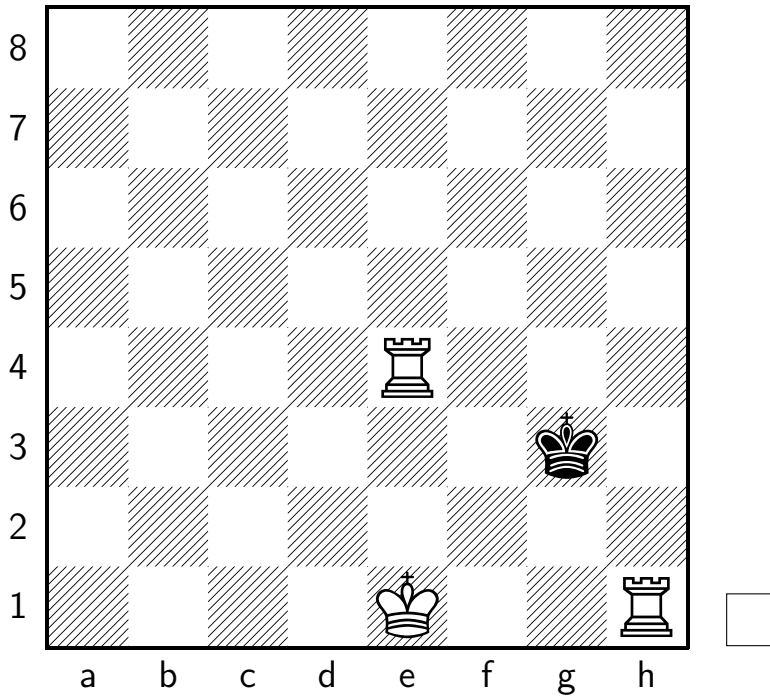
Q4. Mate in 2. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Paul Morphy, 1910 (YACPDB: 625426)

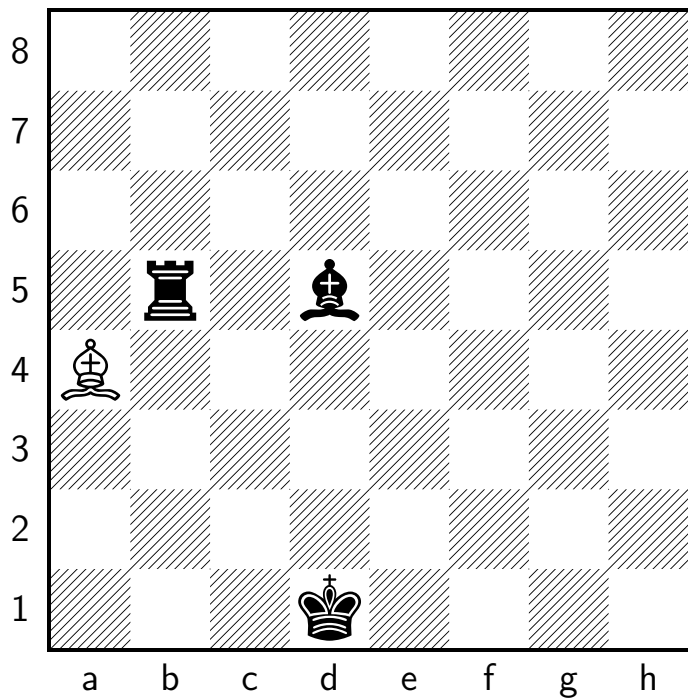
Q5. Mate in 2. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: W. E. Candy, 1911 (YACPDDB: 3889)

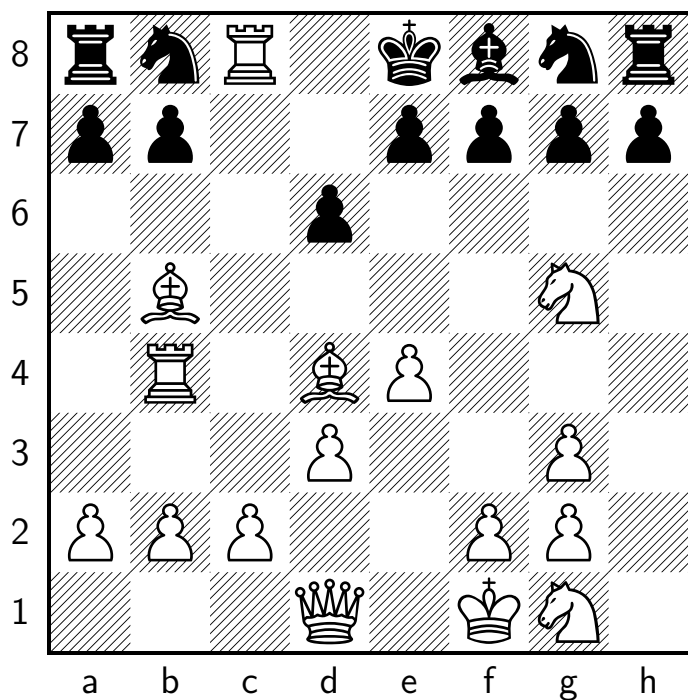
Q6. What is the missing piece? Whose turn is it? Which square does the missing piece belong on? Show the previous moves that reached this position. (8 marks)



Answer:

Source: Raymond M. Smullyan: The Chess Mysteries of the Arabian Knights

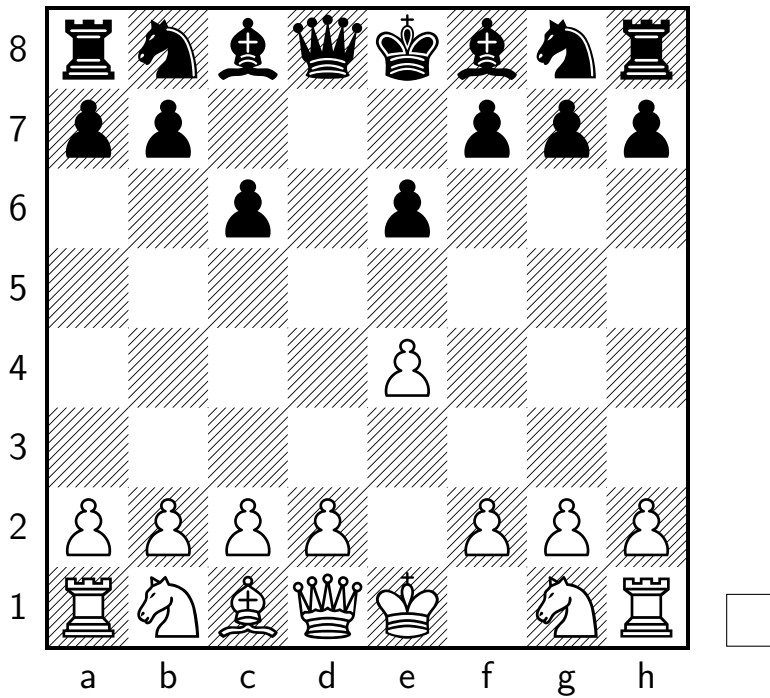
Q7. WHO moved last? WHICH piece was moved from WHERE to WHERE? (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Noam Elkies, U.S. Problem Bulletin, 1995

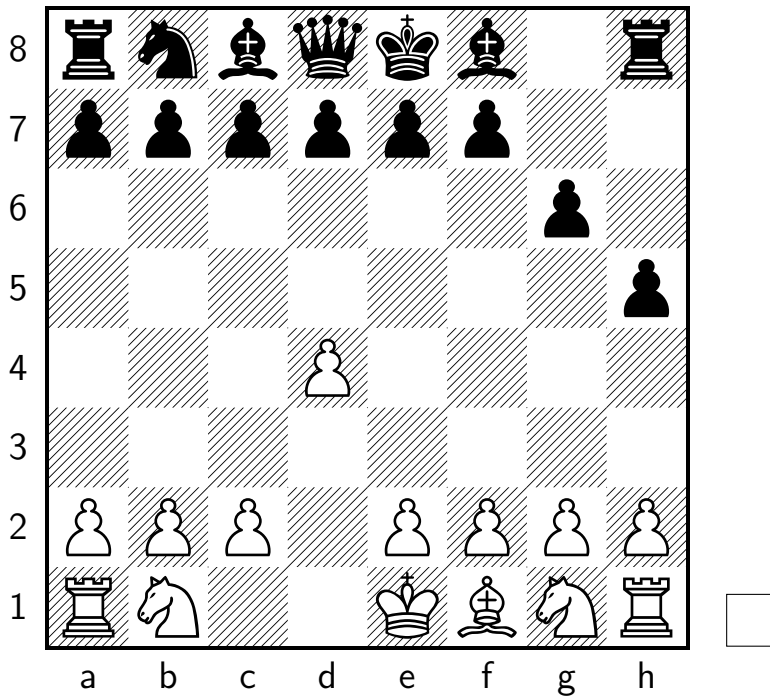
Q8. The position below occurred after the Black's 4th move, from the starting position. Show the moves to reach this position. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Tibor Orbán, Die Schwalbe, 1976

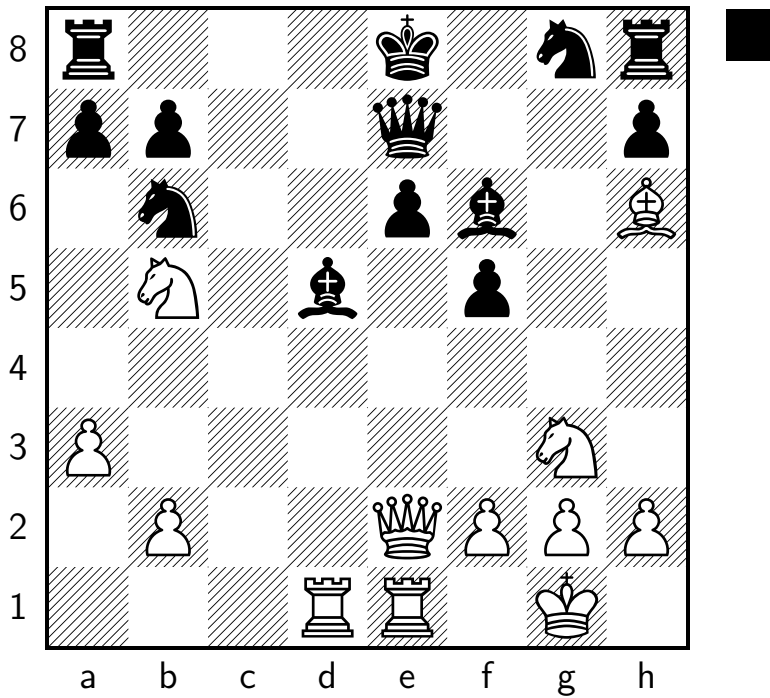
Q9. The position below occurred after the Black's 4th move, from the starting position. Show the moves to reach this position. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: L. Mano, source unknown, 1999

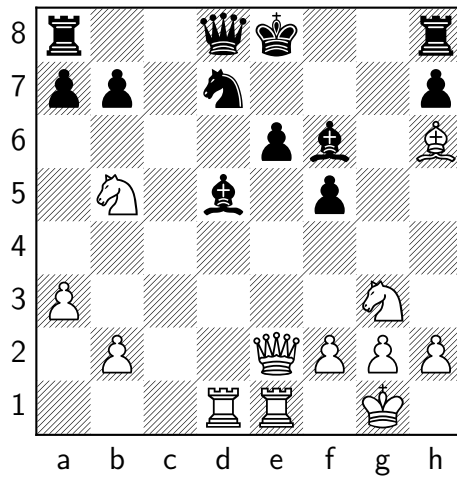
Q10. Helpmate in 1. What is Black's move to allow White a "Mate in 1"? Answer Black move's first, then White's checkmates. (6 marks)



Answer:

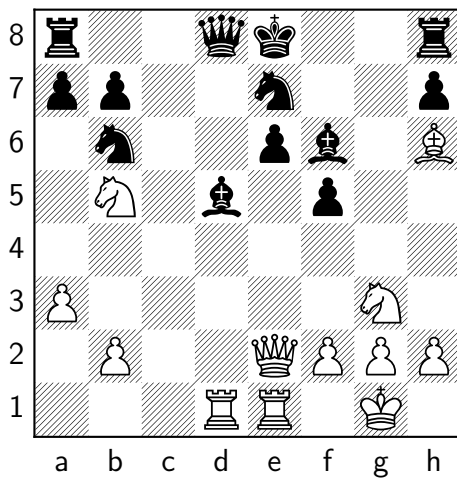
11. Helpmate in 1. Black's positions are all different, but White's positions are all same as the previous question. (6 marks each)

Q11A.



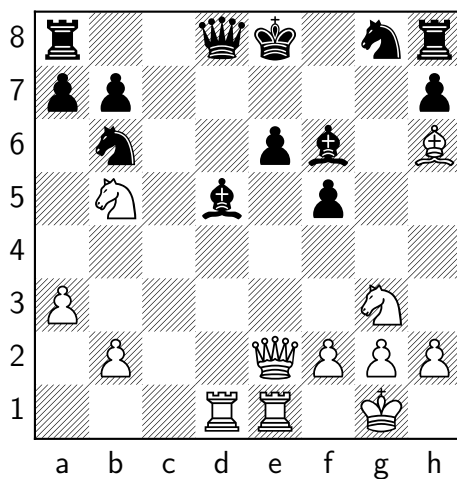
Answer:

Q11B.



Answer:

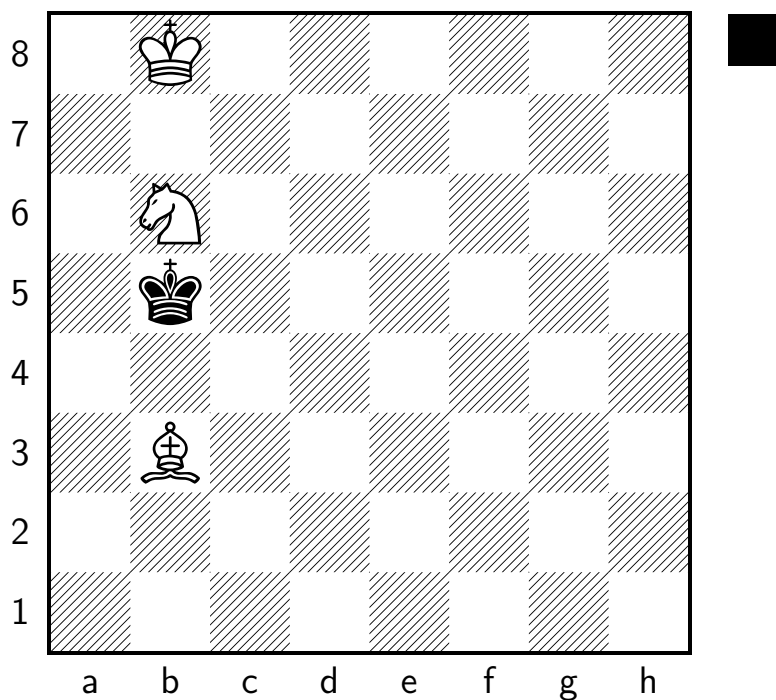
Q11C.



Answer:

Source: Jeff Coakley, Winning Chess Puzzles for Kids Vol. 2

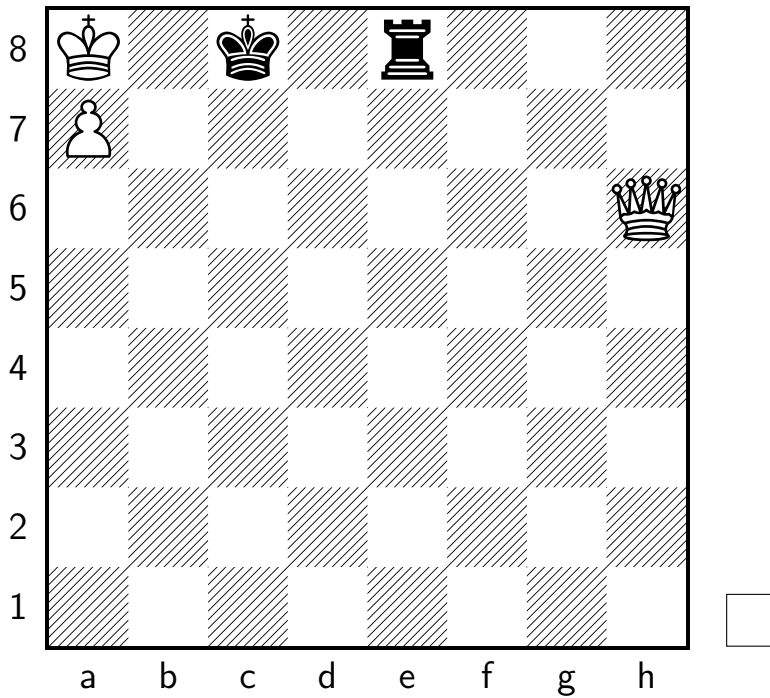
Q12. Helpmate in 3. Black moves 1st and White checkmates with their 3rd move. (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Hilmar Ebert, Schach-Echo, 1977 (YACPDB: 638060)

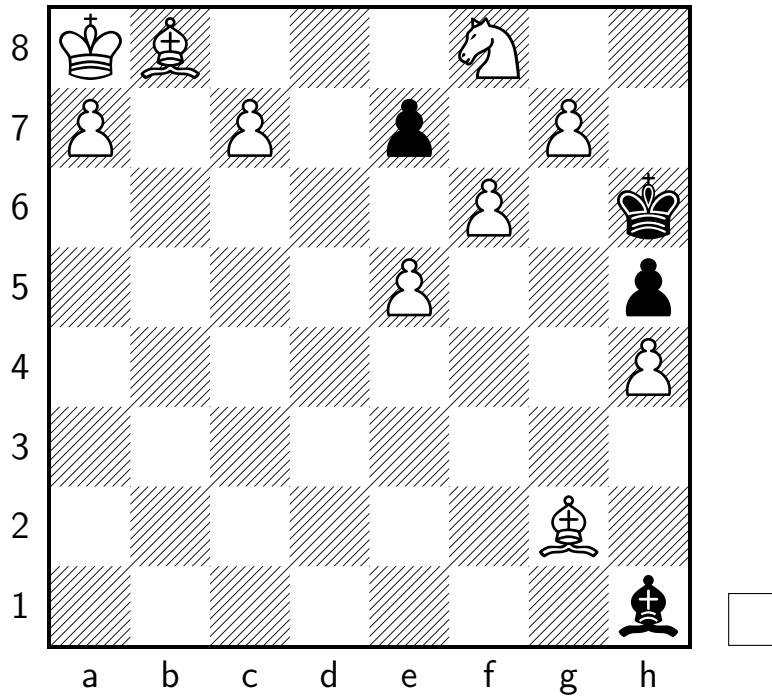
Q13. Selfmate in 2. White forces Black to checkmate White's King with Black's 2nd move. (NB This must be a forced variation as Black will try and avoid checkmating White if possible!) (6 marks)



Answer:

Source: Wilhelm Krämer, Die Schwalbe, 1928 (YACPDB: 106430)

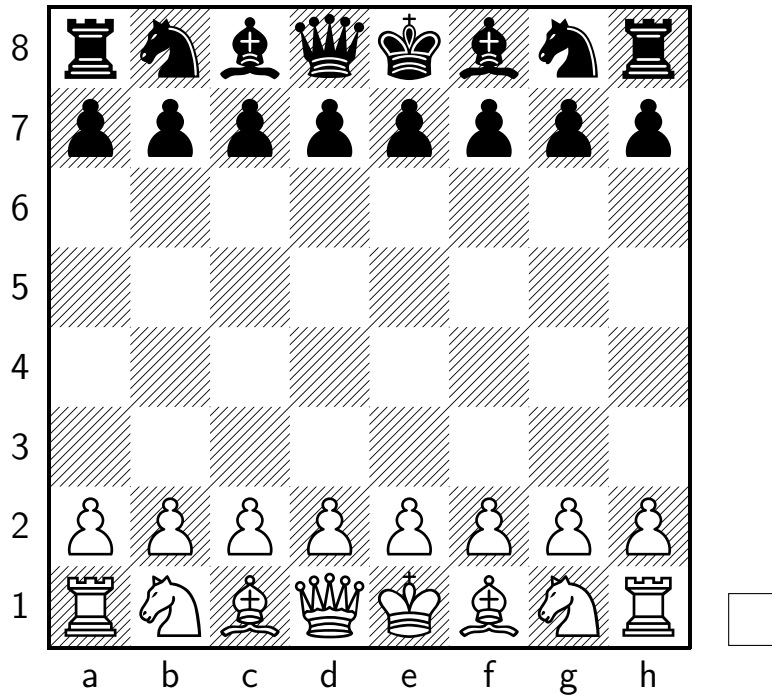
Q14. Selfmate in 2. White forces Black to checkmate White in 2 moves. (8 marks)



Answer:

Source: Wolfgang Pauly, The Theory of Pawn Promotion, 1912 (YACPDDB: 47304)

Q15. White to play. Who wins?



Answer:

Source: Composer unknown, date unknown